

LISTENING

#35

1 – Listen to a conversation between a customer and a shop employee in a souvenir store. Pay attention to the gifts the employee suggests, why the customer rejects them, and how the conversation develops.

Souvenir Shop

1 - Who is the customer buying a souvenir for?

2 - What is the first item the employee suggests?

- a) A watch
- b) A shirt
- c) A pearl necklace

3 - Why does the customer reject it?

- a) His wife already has one
- b) It is broken
- c) It is not local

4 - How much does the traditional shirt cost?

5 - Why does the customer become upset with the employee?

- a) The employee closes the store early
- b) The employee suggests he is cheap
- c) The employee refuses to help him

6 - What does the employee say about the other souvenir shops?

- a) They are cheaper
- b) They are closer to the airport
- c) They have already closed

7 - What inexpensive item does the customer consider buying?

8 - What kind of chocolates does the employee suggest instead?

- a) Swiss chocolates
- b) Belgian chocolates
- c) Local chocolates

9 - What does the employee do at the end of the conversation?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

The Difficult Gift Decision

When Lucas traveled abroad for work, he promised his family that he would bring back souvenirs from his trip. Finding gifts for his children was easy. He bought a toy airplane for his son and a small stuffed animal for his daughter.

Choosing a gift for his wife, however, was much more difficult.

At first, Lucas considered buying jewelry, but everything he liked was far beyond his budget. Then he looked at perfumes, but he was afraid of choosing a fragrance she would not enjoy. He walked through several shops without finding anything that felt right.

Just before returning to his hotel, Lucas entered a small local market. There he found handmade ceramic cups painted by local artists. Each cup had a different design inspired by the city's history and culture.

The cups were not expensive, but they were unique and meaningful. Lucas chose a blue one because it reminded him of the ocean near their hometown. He also bought a small bag of locally roasted coffee to go with it.

When he returned home, his wife smiled as soon as she opened the gift. She told him that she loved receiving something that represented the place he had visited rather than an expensive item from a luxury store.

Lucas learned that the best souvenirs are not always the most expensive ones. Sometimes, a thoughtful gift means much more.

Comprehension Questions

1 - Why was it difficult for Lucas to buy a gift for his wife?

2 - What gift did Lucas finally choose?

3 - Why did Lucas choose the blue cup?

4 - Do you prefer receiving practical gifts or sentimental gifts? Why?

5 - What is the best souvenir or gift you have ever received?
